



End Term (Even) Semester Examination May-June 2025

Name of the Program and semester: **B.A. English**

Semester: **VI**

Name of the Course: **Literary Criticism**

Course Code: **EED- 601 (A)**

Time: 3 hours

Maximum Marks: 100

Note:

- (i) All the questions are compulsory.
- (ii) Answer any two sub questions from a, b and c in each main question.
- (iii) Total marks for each question is 20 (twenty).
- (iv) Each sub-question carries 10 marks.

Q1	(20marks)	
(a)	Analyze how the phrase "spontaneous overflow" contrasts with "recollected in tranquility" as discussed by Wordsworth in his <i>Preface to Lyrical Ballads</i> .	CO1
(b)	Elaborate Coleridge's critique of Wordsworth's theory of language and poetic diction in <i>Biographia Literaria</i> in contribution to the formation of a distinct Romantic tradition.	
(c)	Discuss the types of imagination as defined and discussed by Coleridge in <i>Biographia Literaria</i> .	
Q2	(20 marks)	
(a)	Explain Virginia Woolf's views on how the historical context of the early 20th century influenced her call for a new form of fiction.	CO2
(b)	Critically evaluate Eliot's argument that a poet must develop a historical sense.	
(c)	Analyze the strengths and limitations of Eliot's vision of criticism. Does his model of 'impersonal criticism' fit into today's literary discourse?	
Q3	(20 marks)	
(a)	Analyze how Cleanth Brooks critiques the traditional notion of poetic meaning in 'The Heresy of Paraphrase'. In what ways does this essay reflect the core principles of New Criticism?	CO3
(b)	Discuss Maggie Humm's contribution to feminist literary criticism. How does <i>Practising Feminist Criticism</i> define the aims and methods of feminist reading?	
(c)	Examine Maggie Humm's discussion of key feminist issues such as gender, authorship, and textuality. How does she argue for a re-reading of literary texts from a feminist perspective?	
Q4	(20 marks)	
(a)	In <i>Principles of Literary Criticism</i> , Richards emphasizes the importance of understanding a poem's total effect rather than isolated parts. Discuss this idea with reference to his method of practical criticism.	CO4
(b)	How does <i>Practical Criticism</i> by I.A. Richards redefine the role of the reader in the process of literary interpretation? Discuss with examples from Richards' experiments.	
(c)	Critically evaluate Richards' concepts of 'stock response', 'mnemonic irrelevance', and 'sentimentalism' as barriers to proper literary judgment.	
Q5	(20 marks)	
(a)	Explain how Richards' <i>Practical Criticism</i> contributed to the development of New Criticism. In what ways did it pave the way for a focus on 'close reading'?	CO4 & CO5



End Term (Even) Semester Examination May-June 2025

(b)	Discuss Wordsworth's theory of poetry as expressed in the <i>Preface to Lyrical Ballads</i> . How does he redefine the subject matter and language of poetry	
(c)	Analyze how I.A. Richards in Chapter 34 of <i>Principles of Literary Criticism</i> redefines the purpose of literary criticism. What role does 'value judgement' play in his framework?	